MIMOLETTE

THE BASICS

MAKE:	Hard
SUB MAKE:	Cheeses which acidify in the mould
POST-MAKE:	Flavoured or Smoked
SUB POST-MAKE:	Insects (mites, maggots)
TYPICAL AGE PROFILE:	Three to 24 months
APPROXIMATE WEIGHT(S):	3-4kg
GEOGRAPHICAL ORIGIN:	Northern France, but made in other locations
PROTECTED STATUS:	N/A
SPECIES OF MILKING ANIMAL:	Cow
BREED OF COW:	Breed not specified
RAW/PASTEURISED MILK:	Examples of both depending on cheesemaker
VEGETARIAN/ANIMAL RENNET:	Typically animal rennet
COMMONLY ENCOUNTERED VARIATIONS:	N/A



THE STORY

There's no mistaking a mature Mimolette, thanks to its cannonball shape, bright orange interior and craggy rind, which comes from allowing tiny cheese mites to burrow into the surface, while also creating unique flavours and textures.

The cheese was developed in Flanders during the 17th century Franco-Dutch war (possibly at the request of King Louis XIV). Holland refused to export its popular cheese Edam to the French, so they developed their own copy cat version, adding the orange pigment annatto to give it a point of difference. The cheese is also known as Boule de Lille after the city where it was first matured.

Mimolette is made following the hard cheese process. As with Aged Gouda, the curds are washed to remove lactose – a process which keep the pH relatively high. The cheeses are moulded and pressed, and acidify on the press, before being brined.

THE CHARACTER

Mimolette can be eaten at just a few months old when it is mild and pliable, but is often matured for much longer. The très vielle (very old) cheese is aged for up to 24 months and has an extraordinary pitted rind, luminous orange colour and brittle texture. The flavour is full of sweet, dairy notes.

PERFECT PARTNERS:

The spice of Malbec provides an interesting counterpoint, but Belgian farmhouse ales, such as tart and fruity saisons, are hard to beat.

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